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I have the following suggestions:

1. Provide a DVD-ROM (instead of 700MB CD-ROM) along with the magazine so that video tutorials, industry talks, etc could also be included.

2. Divide construction projects into beginners, intermediate and advanced levels. Instead of regular microcontroller-based projects, include projects based on VLSI, RTOS, DSP and Matlab.

3. Monthly tutorials on the above topics would be very helpful. Use of open source tools and tutorials would help in assembling these projects.

4. Initiate electronics community in cities.

5. Organise national-level project competitions.

Hari

Through e-mail

☐ Please include in EFY the details of Cygwin compiler by GNU. I have found it very useful in programming the AVR microcontroller for my project on bomb-detection robot.

Vishal Meshram

Through e-mail

SCR Phase-Angle Control

In the 'SCR Phase Angle Control Using Microcontroller' project published in EFY Nov. 2009, in the delay(int) function timer 0 was initialised with 0xFC17 to produce a delay of 1 ms. But the oscillation frequency is 12 MHz and the timer will count 1/12th of this frequency. It means that for producing the delay, it should be initialised with the hex value of 1000 (which is 0x03E3). I searched the datasheet of 8051 microcontroller for related details but I am still confused. Please help.

Ravikumar V.

Through e-mail

The author, Ashutosh M. Bhatt, replies:

The timer is initialised to FC17h=64535d. It overflows at FFFFh = 65535d. That means once the timer is started, it will overflow after counting 1000 internal clock pulses, which means a delay of 1000 microseconds (1 millisecond).

Set-Top Box

The 'Inside Set-Top Box' article published in January issue was very in-

formative. I am using Reliance BIG TV DTH at home. The STB provided by the company has a TV antenna input port as well as VHF/UHF output port at the rear side. As the company has not provided any operating manual for the STB, I am unable to make out the purpose of these provisions. Please help.

Subhash Shyamsundar

Through e-mail

The author, Amit Goel, replies:

The TV antenna input port is used for terrestrial antenna input. This enables you to provide analogue signal to your set-top box. For example, you can connect your regular cable connection input or terrestrial antenna input to watch TV programmes.

RF out or VHF/UHF output port is used for analogue signal output. Some of the old TV sets don't have support for composite or component video signals. In that case, this port helps in connecting to TV. It can also be connected to a recorder.

For STB details, visit Big TV website (<http://bigtv.co.in/features-set-box2.html>).

Quiz Program in JavaScript

After unzipping the 'Quiz in JavaScript' folder from EFY-CD of January issue, I copied the quiz.htm file in the PWS (Personal Web Server) root directory and opened the page through IE browser. But I am getting a non-interactive screen with no questions and no active links. Please help.

Jagdish Gupta

Through e-mail

The author, Bukya Sridhar, replies:

When the program is run, the screen will appear blank only. Next, you have to follow the steps given below:

1. Click either 'Start Quiz with Timer' or 'Next Question' button. 'Start Quiz with Timer' will initiate by popping up an alert box. Clicking 'Next Question' will bring up the interface.

2. Select the option for choice of question using the mouse.

3. Click 'Check Current Answer' button. It will update the fields with results. The quiz ends if the timer counts from 120 seconds down to 0. For details, click 'Help' menu.